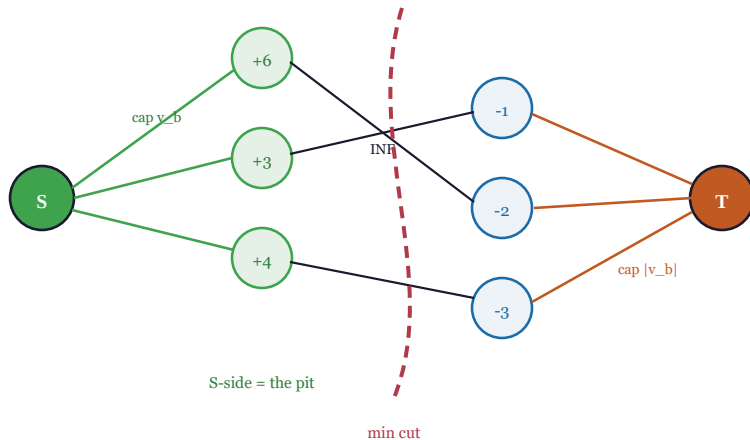


block model + slope precedence



a block is mineable only if the blocks above it (its slope predecessors) are mined

Picard max-closure = min s-t cut



optimal pit = source side of the minimum cut; pit value = $(\sum \text{positive } v_b) - \text{maxflow}$ (Picard 1976).

The infinite-capacity precedence arcs force any feasible cut to respect the slope constraints exactly.